Daily Bible Note

Date: 2026-11-04

I. Today's Reading

NKJV: Amos 1:9-15

9 Thus says the LORD: "For three transgressions of Tyre, and for four, I will not turn away its punishment, because they delivered up the whole captivity to Edom, and did not remember the covenant of brotherhood.

10 But I will send a fire upon the wall of Tyre, which shall devour its palaces."

11 Thus says the LORD: "For three transgressions of Edom, and for four, I will not turn away its punishment, because he pursued his brother with the sword, and cast off all pity; his anger tore perpetually, and he kept his wrath forever.

12 But I will send a fire upon Teman, which shall devour the palaces of Bozrah."

13 Thus says the LORD: "For three transgressions of the people of Ammon, and for four, I will not turn away its punishment, because they ripped open the women with child in Gilead, that they might enlarge their territory.

14 But I will kindle a fire in the wall of Rabbah, and it shall devour its palaces, amid shouting in the day of battle, and a tempest in the day of the whirlwind.

15 Their king shall go into captivity, he and his princes together," says the LORD.

II. Key Summary

• The LORD announces that for three transgressions of Tyre, and for four, He will not turn away its punishment, because they delivered up the whole captivity to Edom and did not remember the covenant of brotherhood; He will send a fire upon the wall of Tyre (vv. 9–10).

• For three transgressions of Edom, and for four, because he pursued his brother with the sword, cast off all pity, his anger tore perpetually, and he kept his wrath forever, the LORD will send a fire upon Teman and devour the palaces of Bozrah (vv. 11–12).

• For three transgressions of the people of Ammon, and for four, because they ripped

open the women with child in Gilead to enlarge their territory, the LORD will kindle a fire in the wall of Rabbah, and their king and princes shall go into captivity together (vv. 13–15).

III. Passage Analysis

Each Circle Closer

> Then, as to those enemies themselves, the order is not of place or time, but of their relation to God's people. ⋯ then Tyre, not an oppressor, as these, yet violating a relation which they had not, the bonds of a former friendship and covenant ⋯ Then follow Edom, Ammon, Moab, who burst the bonds of blood also. Lastly and nearest of all, it falls on Judah⋯ [1]

The previous passage (1:3-8) named Damascus and Gaza, who had oppressed Israel; this passage (1:9-15) begins to use the word "brother": Tyre "did not remember the covenant of brotherhood" (v. 9), and Edom "pursued his brother with the sword" (v. 11).

The further down the list, the closer the named nations are to Israel (for the judgment on Judah and Israel, see 2:4-16).

He Kept His Wrath Forever

> Edom too remembered the relation, but to hate him. ⋯ He retained it when he ought to have parted with it, and let it loose when he ought to have restrained it. [2]

Verse 11 piles up four phrases: "pursued his brother with the sword," "cast off all pity," "his anger tore perpetually," and "kept his wrath forever."

The one he attacked was his brother, yet Edom's anger stopped at "forever" and was never put away.

Note: When did these things happen?

- Tyre did not remember the covenant of brotherhood (v. 9): "There was peace between Hiram and Solomon, and the two of them made a treaty together" (1 Kings 5:12), and Hiram called Solomon "my brother" (1 Kings 9:13). [3]
- Edom pursued his brother with the sword (v. 11): "Esau hated Jacob ⋯ and Esau said in his heart, '⋯ then I will kill my brother Jacob'" (Genesis 27:41). When Israel came out of

Egypt and asked to pass through, Edom said, "You shall not pass through my land, lest I come out against you with the sword" (Numbers 20:18) [3]. In the days of Jehoshaphat, the people of Mount Seir joined Ammon and Moab to attack Judah (2 Chronicles 20:10-11); in the days of Jehoram, "Edom revolted against Judah's authority, and made a king over themselves" (2 Kings 8:20-22), and shed "innocent blood in their land" (Joel 3:19). This was long-standing hostility, not a single event. [2]

- Ammon ripped open the women with child in Gilead (v. 13): This event is not recorded in Kings or Chronicles. After Hazael struck "all the land of Gilead" (2 Kings 10:32-33), Gilead's weakness may have encouraged Ammon to try to seize it. Back in the days of the judges, the king of Ammon already claimed the land "from the Arnon as far as the Jabbok, and to the Jordan" as his own (Judges 11:13). [4]
- Afterward:
    - Tyre: In 734 B.C. it paid tribute to Tiglath-pileser of Assyria; later it endured a thirteen-year siege by Nebuchadnezzar; in 332 B.C. Alexander the Great took it, and 30,000 of its people were sold into slavery. [5][6]
    - Edom: Teman and Bozrah were struck in some degree by Sennacherib, and more especially by Nebuchadnezzar. [2]
    - Ammon: In 734 B.C. it was conquered by Tiglath-pileser III of Assyria [6]; later its king and princes were carried away by the king of Babylon. [3]
    - Israel: About 40 years after Amos, Assyria did just what Amos said and attacked Israel, carrying the people away (2 Kings 17). [7]

IV. Reflection Question

If things between you and someone in your family have been bad for many years, and you have even hurt each other a few times, how will you face that relationship?

Edom and Israel were brothers, yet from Esau onward, generation after generation, Edom "pursued his brother with the sword" and "kept his wrath forever" [2]; the LORD said, "I will not turn away its punishment," and would send a fire upon Teman to devour the palaces of Bozrah.

References

[1] BibleHub, Barnes' Notes on the Bible (Amos 1:3), https://biblehub.com/commentaries/amos/1-3.htm

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[3] Blue Letter Bible, Matthew Henry Commentary (Amos 1), https://www.blueletterbible.org/comm/mhc/Amo/Amo_001.cfm

[4] BibleHub, Jamieson-Fausset-Brown; Benson Commentary; Keil & Delitzsch (Amos 1:13), https://biblehub.com/commentaries/amos/1-13.htm

[5] BibleHub, Cambridge Bible for Schools and Colleges (S. R. Driver, Amos 1:9), https://biblehub.com/commentaries/amos/1-9.htm

[6] 華人基督徒查經資料網站 (Chinese Christian Bible Study), Amos 1 notes (Ryrie Study Bible notes), https://www.ccbiblestudy.org/Old%20Testament/30Amos/30GT01.htm

[7] BibleProject, Book of Amos guide, https://bibleproject.com/guides/book-of-amos/